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Sermon preached in Wahroonga church by DR. C. E. WENIGER, Sabbath, October 13

"Arise, Shine; for Thy Light Is Come"

THERE are some Bible texts that stand forth with a special glory, that cause one's chest to expand, that make his heart beat a little faster, that broaden his vision, that make him stand on tiptoe for the things of God. Among these texts is the one that has been brought to us in the sacred song. My text is Isaiah 60, verses 1-3. "Arise, shine; for thy light is come, and the glory of the Lord is risen upon thee. For, behold, the darkness shall cover the earth, and gross darkness the people: but the Lord shall arise upon thee, and His glory shall be seen upon thee. And the Gentiles shall come to thy light, and kings to the brightness of thy rising." It is a beautiful scene: a night, a sunrise, and the glorious accession into the church of God of those who before have not known His name.

Light has always been a symbol of God's presence from the very beginning of the Good Book. From Genesis on through the Revelation, we find light streaming from the pages. God said at the very beginning, "Let there be light," and there was light. Adam and Eve dwelt in an atmosphere of light, and even when they went forth from the garden it was the light that shone from the cross that was their strength and stay, and pointed a better way. Light was enshrouded in a pillar, leading the children of Israel through the desert. Light blazed on Sinai. Light rested on the mercy seat. Light filled the temple of Solomon. And when Jesus of Nazareth came, God in the flesh, light appeared on the hills of Bethlehem, in clouds of glory.

The story is one of light from beginning to end, so that one might well recall verse 5 of Revelation 22: "And there shall be no night there; and they need no candle, neither light of the sun; for the Lord God giveth them light." Light, the symbol of God's presence; the evidence of His presence in our lives from moment to moment. Yes, light has always been a symbol of God's presence. God is light, and he who dwelleth in God, dwelleth in light.

Now, it came to pass that God chose to reveal His light in His Son Christ Jesus. And it is not strange that Jesus Himself should take the word "light" and make it one of the most prominent words in His teaching. In John chapter 8, verse 12, I find the record saying, "Then spake Jesus again unto them, saying, I am the light of the world: he that followeth Me shall not walk in darkness, but shall have the light of life." It is very significant to notice the locale of this message of Jesus. When He said, "I am the light of the world," He was standing in the court of the temple.

It was in this court, you will recall, that there were two great standards, and it was the custom at the time of the evening sacrifice to light great lamps at the top of these standards. The light, it is said, was shed all over the sacred enclosure of the temple; but more than that, it shone over a great part of Jerusalem at the time of the evening sacrifice. As these lights were kindled there was music and dancing and song in praise of the Author of all light. The light, we are told, commemorated the pillar of light that led the children of Israel through the desert and symbolized the coming of the Messiah, who should be the Light of the world. And yet the symbols were

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unintelligible to many who saw them in all their beauty at the time of the evening sacrifice.

When Jesus said, "I am the Light of the world," it was not evening. He was standing in the place where these glorious lights were kindled at eventide, but it was very early in the morning, we are told. The sun was just rising above Olivet, it was just touching the buildings of Jerusalem. It was coming in all its glory upon the temple enclosure, upon the white marble of the central building, and the golden vine that went up its sides. It was a thing of beauty to behold. And in that setting, looking upon the glorious sunrise, and the reflection of that sun all about, Jesus said, "I am the Light of the world: he that followeth Me shall not walk in darkness, but shall have the light of life."

To everyone who sits in darkness, to everyone who yearns for light, this same Jesus said, "I am come a light into the world, that whosoever believeth on Me should not abide in darkness." John 12: 46. And so thoroughly was this idea of light ingrained in the thinking of John, that you will recall when he sat down to write the life of Jesus, he made the word very prominent in his introduction to the book. And as you read down the first few verses of John, chapter 1, you will hear John saying, "In Him was life; and the life was the light of men. And the light shineth in darkness; and the darkness comprehended it not. . . . That was the true Light, which lighteth every man that cometh into the world." As the Father revealed Himself in His Son Christ Jesus, so He may reveal Himself in every one of His children: that means you and me. Psalm 36, verse 9: "For with Thee is the fountain of life: in Thy light shall we see light." It is through contact with Christ that we are able to begin to reveal the life of light that came in Jesus.

"Ye are the light of the world. A city that is set on an hill cannot be hid. Neither do men light a candle, and put it under a bushel, but on a candlestick; and it giveth light unto all that are in the house. Let your light so shine before men, that they may see your good works, and glorify your Father which is in heaven." The idea is not new. It is an old idea. Jerusalem, Palestine, was put in the highway of the nations that it might be a light to the world. It failed, signally failed, till that great Light came.

God has always had lights. You can name them, beginning with the patriarchs, down through the period of Jesus, and then down through the Middle Age period, down through the beginning of this blessed advent movement. He has always had lights, and now to you and me this Sabbath morning I should like to say in a new way, you and I are the light of the world, if we will accept that privilege. It's a dark world; it's not growing any lighter.

I think just now of an experience of twenty years ago. I sat in a great assembly in the city of Detroit in North America, at a Student Volunteer Convention. There were four or five thousand young people from all over the world attending that Christian convention, and their aim was to learn better how to tell Christ to the world.

That convention had been dominated by an evolutionary point of view, by a very modernist way of thinking, and day after day we listened to men suggesting these damning modern ideas, instead of holding up the cross of Christ. And I remember one day, toward the close of the convention, time was offered for a question hour. I can hear a young man speaking still, standing in the gallery. He rose and said: "I should like to know, Mr. Chairman, if there is any other way to God than through Christ Jesus?" The chairman did not answer the question, he ignored it. Then another man rose and said: "I should like to know is there any other name by which a man may be saved than by the name Christ Jesus?" That question likewise was ignored.

That, I repeat, was twenty years ago. Has it grown any better? Has it grown any better in men's thinking? Are you aware, my brethren and sisters, that we have living all about us now a group of young people maturing who are the second generation of those who have not attended church or Sunday school? That is the actual condition of it; not the first generation, but many of them, vast hordes of them are the boys and girls, the sons and daughters of mothers and fathers who did not attend church, who did not attend Sunday school; and their thinking is far removed from the things that you and I love.

In contemporary modern thinking, sin is not sin; sin is expediency—nothing more or less than that. There is no absolute; life is purely relative. Salvation is only socially better men, only gradual development. We are living in the darkness of modern paganism. Let your light shine! It was again impressed upon me at the Jenolan Caves just the other day, when for effect our guide at several points extinguished all the lights and we found ourselves in palpable darkness, dreadful darkness, and then, from that deep night down in the cavern of the earth there flashed light; and we gazed upon a thing of beauty. Let your light shine out of the darkness of the day. But underneath this darkness there is a cry for light, and most of these folk want to see the light, they want to seek God.

"The men whom I have seen succeed best in life have always been cheerful and hopeful men, who went about their business with a smile on their faces, and took the changes and chances of this mortal life like men, facing rough and smooth alike as it came."

—Charles Kingsley.

Now to come directly to the focus of our thinking. This church, like many other churches, if not all other churches, is passing through a series of stages, and I wonder if the historian who would objectively sit down to write the history of the Seventh-day Adventist group, might not say that during this period in which we find ourselves now, we are tarrying in the **institutional** period. The period in which we are prone to depend, not on the individual light shining through a consecrated Christian, but we are prone to depend upon institutions, departments, methods, procedures, manners, ways of doing things, rather than upon the Spirit of God in a consecrated member of the faith who is letting his light shine. We are depending, be it said to our shame, on organized religion, and not enough upon the individual light that God wants to shine through us as members of His great, great church.

What does that mean? The world is watching you and me. Our influence upon others depends not so much upon what we say, as upon what we are. We read in "Desire of Ages": "Men may combat and defy our logic, they may resist our appeal; but a life of disinterested love is an argument they cannot gainsay. A consistent life characterized by the meekness of Christ is a power in the world." And as the "Ministry of Healing" says, "The strongest argument in favour of the gospel is a loving and lovable Christian."

I had a dear step-father who passed away just two years ago, the only father I ever knew. He came into my life when I was a boy. Shortly after that my mother and I became members of the church of God. Father, not being a Christian, very heartily opposed, more than that, he made it very difficult for mother and me. I do not recall during the forty years of that experience hearing my mother once sit down with my father and discuss with him the doctrine of the Sabbath, or the doctrine of the second coming of Christ, or the doctrine of baptism by immersion, or, or, or—I do not recall them. But I do know that after thirty years my father began to permit my mother to read the Word of God to him in the evening before they went to bed. And after a little longer, I remember, he asked her to say a little prayer aloud for him, before he went to sleep. And after a little longer, he began to open the Bible as she opened it, and just a few months before he died he said to me one day: "Charles, will you baptize me? I want to be a member of the faith that mother and you are members of." My brethren and sisters, it was not tracts—they have their place; it was not organized religion; it was not Bible readings; it was the consistent, loving life of my mother, under God, that won my father, as a child of God. "The strongest argument in favour of the gospel is a loving and lovable Christian."

But we have come into a strange time, in this institutionalized time we divide our work, and we say this is a great work, and that is an unimportant work. Here is the work of the minister, and well, she's just a home-maker. And, here is the work of the teacher, and, oh, he's just a farmer. And here is the work of the doctor, and, oh, she's just a nurse, he's just an orderly, and so on. God knows nothing about it; all service ranks the same with God, if it is sincerely and well done.

"Ye are the light of the world." The Jews sought to confine the benefits of salvation to their own nation. Christ showed them that salvation is like the sunshine, it belongs to the whole world. The religion of the Bible is not to be confined between the covers of a book, nor within the walls of a church. It is not to be brought out occasionally for our own benefit, and then to be carefully laid aside again. It is to sanctify the daily life; to manifest itself in every business transaction, and in all our social relations.

"Because they can serve only in little things, they think themselves justified in doing nothing. In this they err. A man may be in the active service of God while

engaged in the ordinary, everyday duties, while felling trees, clearing the ground-following the plough. The mother who trains her children for Christ is as truly working for God, as is the minister in the pulpit." ("Prophets and Kings.") All are doing their duty and honouring their religion as much while working at the wash tub, or washing the dishes, as they are in going to meetings.

Now, that is real religion. That is letting the light shine. And as I go up and down the sacred halls of our sanitarium—I say **sacred halls**—I am aware that the kindly greeting of the physician as he meets his patients in the morning; the sweet morning care of the nurse as she ministers to the patients; the little evening prayer that is spoken before she leaves the patient's room; the good, clean work done when the steps are cleaned, when the hall is mopped, when the grounds are kept clean, when the bushes are trimmed—all of these things are a part of the work of God, and if we are doing them well, conscientiously, to the best of our ability, at the call of God, they are accepted and our light shines forth, and someone will be won into the precious faith because you and I live a loving and lovable Christian life full of efficient service for Him.

What is the secret of the light? What makes it shine? Mrs. Weniger and I one evening attended a great military exhibition, in one of the greatest stadiums on earth; there were 110,000 people present. During the evening's programme, as announced, all the lights were extinguished, and we sat in darkness under a dark sky; there was no moonlight. And then a young sergeant rose, we were told, at the far end of the amphitheatre, struck a match. All could see the light from the one match—it flickered and went out. And then he said: "Will all of you take from your pockets the match that we asked you to bring; take it out, and be ready to strike it when I say." You could hear people taking out their matches. Then he said, "Strike!" and almost instantly, I suppose ninety thousand matches came into full light, and that great area glowed with light! A beautiful sight. They flickered and went out, until again we were in the blackness of the night.

And then something happened! There, piercing the darkness, 188 great searchlights glowed, fingers directed up toward the heavens, and we sat in amazement at this glorious light.

Then in a little while they converged, and we found ourselves under a great cone of light as they focussed at one point which, we were told in the papers the next day, was seven thousand feet up in the sky. We sat in glorious light! What was the difference, brethren and sisters, between the light of the matches and the light of the searchlights? The matches had no source of continued energy and light; the searchlights were connected with a power-house, and as long as they were connected the light would glow.

"Ye are the light of the world." As long as you and I are connected with the great power-house we shall shine—we shall shine by His glory. Are you connected to Jesus? Those who are truly connected with God, by reflecting the light of heaven will have a saving power in the church, and also in the world, for the perfume of good deeds and truthful acts will make them of good repute, even among those who are not of our faith. Those who fear God will respect and honour such a character, and even the enemies of our faith, as they see the spirit and life of Christ exhibited in their daily works, will glorify God, the source of their strength and honour. "Ye are the light of the world." Shall we, this Sabbath morning, "Arise and shine"? Brethren and sisters, our "light is come."

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The Benefits to the Home Field from the Missions Extension for 1951

W. E. BATTYE

"The Lord is calling upon His people to take up different lines of missionary work, to sow beside all waters. . . . The presentation of the truth in love and sympathy from house to house is in harmony with the instruction of Christ to His disciples when He sent them out on their first missionary tour."

"Each has his place in the eternal plan of Heaven. Each is to work in co-operation with Christ for the salvation of souls. Not more surely is the place prepared for us in the heavenly mansions than is the special place designated on earth where we are to work for God."

"The work above all work—the business above all others which should draw and engage the energies of the soul—is the work of saving souls for whom Christ has died. Make this the main, the important work of your life. Make it your special life-work. Co-operate with Christ in this grand and noble work, and become home and foreign missionaries."

Pastor J. L. Shuler

It is in whole-hearted consecration to the task that blessings and benefits will come to us in our Missions Extension programme for 1951.

At a meeting in Dublin, Ireland, which D. L. Moody attended in the year 1872, the preacher said in a quiet way, "The world has yet to see what God can do with and for and through and in a man who is fully and wholly consecrated to Him." The following week Moody was sitting in Spurgeon's tabernacle, and as his heart was lighted with the torch of Spurgeon's eloquence, he thrilled to the words of the preacher as he said over and over to himself, "'The world has yet to see what God can do with and for and through and in a man who is fully and wholly consecrated to Him.' He meant any man. He didn't say he had to be educated or brilliant or anything else—just a man. Well, by the Holy Spirit in me, I will be one of those men!" In his joy he began to weep. Sympathetic Christians around him, thinking he was under great conviction, learned that it was not sin or penitence, but great joy in a dedication to a high purpose that exercised him.

The world has yet to see what God can do with a man who is wholly consecrated to His will. It was seen once in Jesus, the divine Man, but only imperfectly in other men. But Moody stands high in the list of those with the limitations of human nature who have consecrated their lives to God.

What shall we do? What blessings and benefits may we expect by our efforts for this year, 1951? As we go in the spirit of love to the people around us to attract them to the Saviour, with a whole-souled consecration to the task, we may expect a threefold blessing accompanying the work. First there will be the satisfaction of a work well done. There will be a spiritual revival in the heart by the contacts we make working from house to house, and in the spirit of the Master casting our bread upon the waters. Its result will be an uplift of soul that we have done something in Christ's name.

The second blessing will be to the one who receives the literature. Who can estimate the value of such contacts? How many times have we read that a book or a tract has commenced a train of circumstances that has resulted in untold blessings and has finally meant the conversion of hundreds! Who can tell how our efforts may prosper?

The third blessing is to the fields afar, the needy fields. Over in Guadalcanal during the war the American boys used to meet together Sabbath by Sabbath listening to an appeal by the native pastor who was in sole charge of the district. He desired to send two teachers up in the back country, and appealed for funds to support them. The boys gave thirty-seven dollars for the support of the work, and possibly shortly after they forgot all about the purpose of the money. But a year or so later came the report that through this investment and the faithfulness of these native teachers, thirty-eight souls were added to the Lord. What a wonderful investment—thirty-seven dollars for thirty-eight souls, plus the faithful consecrated efforts and the blessing of God in giving and receiving!

May these blessings descend upon us all as we engage in the work of Missions Extension for 1951.

Our ISLAND FIELDS

OUR HOME BEYOND

O weary heart, there is a home
Beyond the reach of toil and care,
A home where changes never come;
Who would not fain be resting there?

If in thy path some thorns are found,
O think who bore them on His brow.
If grief thy sorrowing heart hath found,
It reached a holier than thou.

Toil on, nor deem, though sore it be,
One sigh unheard, one prayer forgot,
The day of rest will dawn for thee,
Wait, meekly wait, and murmur not.

W. H. Bellamy.

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Medical Missions in the Coral Sea Union

DR. H. E. HARGREAVES

During the past three months it was my pleasant duty to visit our mission stations in this Union, stretching from the highlands of New Guinea right away to the Eastern Solomon Islands; and to meet in council with the president, Pastor H. White, and his committee.

To begin with, I stayed for one week at the Leper Hospital at Mount Hagen, in order to see the exact working of this institution and to advise the Union committee on the taking up of a second similar project in the future.

Here in a pleasant valley far removed from the heat of the coast, our missionaries are staffing a hospital which is caring for one hundred and fifty lepers, and for which the New Guinea administration is paying all expenses. There are two sections in this hospital, one for lepromatous cases, those minus fingers and toes and with all the other disfigurements which one usually associates with this disease, and the other for nerve cases, which are perhaps not so dreadful or dramatic, but which need just as much care and treatment.

Brother Barnard has the direction of the hospital, and with his helpers, Sisters Olive and Elsie Pearce, Brother Aveling, and Brother and Sister Aitken, has made a success of this enterprise. The two sisters take care of the pathological and clinical work which controls the treatment of this disease, and they are assisted by a dozen or more native dressers who work under their direction.

A large area of ground has been put under cultivation, and patients from the hospital now help to raise a large part of their own food, for which work they are suitably paid by the government. They are very happy to be so employed, and yet are not compelled to work at all if disinclined, or unable by reason of physical disability. There is also no compulsion for them to remain under treatment at the hospital; they are perfectly free to go or come as they please, yet one finds that, even after the disease is arrested, and the patient is ready for discharge, he often elects to remain. There is no doubt that the reason for this is the fact that he knows that those who are caring for him have a love for him and that they are not doing this work merely in a professional way, but from a much higher motive, in fact, because they are Christian missionaries.

Brother Aveling looks after the sawmill, high in the mountains, and Brother Aitken oversees the work of the native workmen who are constructing permanent houses. When one considers that this whole enterprise is only two years old, one marvels at the amount of energy that must have been expended, and can only exclaim, "Well done."

And so I said "good-bye" and passed swiftly by air to the steamy heat of New Britain and the Solomon Isles. Blue lagoons and coral atolls spread beneath my gaze for hundreds of miles to the east, in an ocean which looked flat enough when viewed from ten thousand feet, but which was anything but flat when seen from the deck of a little mission ship. However, these stout little ships get you there in the end, and soon I had seen all there was to see of our courageous medical missionaries and their little dispensaries from Kambubu to Kukudu, from Batuna to Kwilibis; examining eyes, listening to chests and hearts, pulling teeth, and generally getting an idea of the health situation among these merry people of the islands.

And so we came to Honiara on the island of Guadalcanal, and to our interview with the government officials there. This was our purpose in our survey of these islands, to advise, and, if possible, obtain permission for a research team from our School of Tropical Medicine in Loma Linda, California, U.S.A., to locate in some place in our Coral Sea Union where they would be able both to carry out their research for the United States Government, and also to assist in our missions' programme. We are very grateful that the British Resident Commissioner and his advisers gave a favourable reply to our request, and we believe that our work on the island of Malaita and the people there will receive a great blessing from this advance move.

As we think of the many places we have visited, and see the need of these peoples; as we travel with our missionaries and visit their schools and little dispensaries, we sometimes ask ourselves, "But where are the doctors?" Here on the island of Malaita there are forty-five thousand people and no doctor. In south-east Papua, around the mission station where Pastor Martin Pascoe is working, there are at least forty thousand people and no doctor. If there are any young men looking forward to a life full of professional interest and missionary service, surely in the Coral Sea Union Mission they will find it. Soon, perhaps, the work of God will be finished, but those who have served in the front line will have no regrets. Let us remember our missionaries and their work in these islands.

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A Growing Work

GEORGE BUTLER

Nearly three weeks with Pastors Newman and Ferguson and helpers in the Solomon Islands, presented a picture much different from what I had read earlier concerning conditions in those islands. Truly the gospel has done a marvellous work.

It was my privilege, with Pastor Eric Hare, to hold Sabbath School institute meetings at several points, and at the same time compare old reports with new summaries. The gospel has made a tremendous change in the lives of a people not long removed from heathenism. There is a hungering for more light, and calls are coming from many new places—an excellent testimony to the example of Christianity.

Not only is there a strong contrast in life, manners, and attitudes between the Christian and heathen villages, but there is also a marked distinction between various phases of Christianity. With some, many of the old customs, habits, and diet are carried over into the so-called new condition. With others the difference between the old and new is very noticeable in every aspect of life.

We can rejoice that we have a message that cleans people up within and without. It is seen on the person, in him, and in his surroundings. His vision and outlook on life are different. He thinks and acts in a different world.

We can also rejoice that we have a fine group of self-sacrificing missionary men and women presenting the gospel and the principles of Christian living, not only among the members of established centres, but also reaching out and setting up the standard in new places. Some of them are in lonely, isolated spots, cut off for years from association with any of their race, without the conveniences they once enjoyed at home, and which we have all the time. But there they remain, calm and serene. The wives are often left alone with the children when the husbands are away seeking out new territory, the while subject to the caprice of stormy seas and the dangers of the jungle.

God bless this loyal army, and may we who are comfortably settled at home remember them daily in our prayers, doing our best by offerings and otherwise to help them finish the task.

JOY FROM SORROW

There are in this world souls whose sorrows spring up into joy for others; whose earthly hopes, laid in the grave with many tears, form the seed whence spring healing flowers and balm for the desolate and the afflicted.—Selected.

With the Yacht "Colleen" Across the Pacific

W. G. FERRIS

From the "Youth's Instructor" I quote the following: "Is there any experience more delightful than an ocean voyage?" The writer, after a very interesting write-up on the joys of modern ocean travelling concludes with the thought, "But the exhilarating sea air and the invigorating exercise give one a tremendous appetite and a zest for living. Do you begin to see what I mean when I say that an ocean trip is one of the most delightful experiences in the world?"

This all sounds very good, but it's not the best reading when one is a thousand miles out from the last port and eight hundred miles from home, on a small yacht with old torn sails moving along at two knots. The captain is a retired navy commmander with an O.B.E. He commanded a destroyer at the battle of Jutland. His present crew consists of a young lad from America, Edwin Edwards from Tonga, Valou from Fiji, and yours truly from Australia. With such a mixture there could be danger ahead! We are on our way from Tahiti to Suva, and three of us are returning home after having delivered to Tahiti their lovely little mission ship the "Colleen." We are longing to reach home. We have been out two weeks from Tahiti, and it will probably be two more before we reach Suva.

The weary days are slowly passing by, and at times the seas are high, and then there are windless days. Life goes on from hour to hour; standing watch on deck, cooking meals, and sleeping. We are travelling on the British yacht "Palmosa," which is on its way from London to Australia. A new crew has joined at each port of call, and as we are anxious to get to Suva we have made up the crew from Tahiti to Fiji, and it's lots of fun but hard work. It is doing us good to learn seamanship at the feet of an ex-captain of the Royal Navy. At watch, on cloudless nights, we talk of such experiences as the "Bounty" passed through; then we say, "Missionaries must be good sailors," and obey like good sailors.

The Lord has been very good to us in our journeys, and we know that He has answered the prayers of His people on both sides of the Pacific, and in the central islands as well. Wherever we have gone there has been intense interest in the "Colleen," which has been given to Tahiti by a generous and wonderfully missionary-minded American doctor. Dr. Lyndon Taylor is a well-known surgeon in Los Angles, and is connected with a number of large medical institutions. The doctor and his wife greatly prized their private yacht "Colleen," and lavished great care on it for a number of years, and the gift has been a real sacrifice. God will bless them for this gift, and He will bless the ship as now it commences its mission work in Tahiti.

It was a thrill to be responsible for this missionary ship "Pitcairn No. 2" from America to its new home. Over fifty years ago the first mission ship, the "Pitcairn," left that land to come to the South Seas, and what a picture can be painted today as the result of those trips! We travelled those same waters going to Tahiti, and the tremendous welcome we received there indicates that a new era has come to the large area of French Oceania.

To tell the whole story of the bringing of the "Colleen" to Tahiti would almost fill a book, and would probably be rather dull reading for those not used to the ways of the sea; but to us who have been closely associated with this venture, it has been a day-by-day revelation of God's love and care for His own. The five-thousand-mile journey was accomplished without accident or distress, and although we were further from land than it is possible to be in any other part of the world, we always felt that God was very near to us.

When out in the Lau Group in May, visiting the churches of the newly formed East Fiji Mission, I was called by radio telephone to proceed to Suva to prepare for this trip to America. It was really hard to leave home just as that time when there was so much of interest happening in the establishment of this new field. But Tahiti needed a ship, and the call was accepted. By plane I travelled alone to Honolulu, and stopped off there to find a young man who had indicated his willingness to become a member of the crew. His name was Clifford Ratz, and he proved to be a wonderful mate although not an Adventist. It was a privilege to meet with so many of our own people in Honolulu over that week-end. They have some beautiful churches. A service in the state prison was a novel experience for me that Sabbath afternoon. Hawaii is a remarkable mission field in that there are so many nationalities all working together in the great cause that we all love so much.

On Sunday evening, May 27, I joined the plane for the mainland. All went well until we were about six hundred miles out, when one engine stopped. The pilot decided to return to Honolulu to have it repaired, and this caused a half-day delay for which the company has written, offering profuse apologies. I was glad of the daylight flight across, for this allowed me to spend considerable time with the pilot during which he gave me valuable information concerning wind conditions over that vast ocean. This proved of great value later.

We flew down the California coast for several hundred miles before sighting Los Angeles, and to me it was a thrill to be by the pilot when he gave his orders to go in for the landing. The other passengers were amazed that I had not been to America before, and one dear old lady said, "If you have been used to speaking Fijian, where did you learn to speak such good American?" Others said, "We can easily tell that you have come from 'Osstralia!'" That made me happy.

Dr. Taylor seemed to have no difficulty in picking out an Adventist, and very soon we were on our way through vast areas, and within two hours we were in working clothes at work on the "Colleen." There were many little things to do to get her ready for the trip, and we had but a few days in which to accomplish them. Dr. and Mrs. Taylor were wonderfully good to me, and provided accommodation at a beautiful hotel at their expense.

I did have an opportunity of seeing many sights of interest and a number of our institutions. Dr. Taylor had two cars, and one was at our disposal at any time. Brother Barcus, who had given the first dollar he ever earned for the building of the "Pitcairn," was very anxious to show me around. He had worked hard with Dr. Taylor in preparing the "Colleen," and had given many weeks in welding tanks and in putting the finishing touches to the cabin. He drove me out to see the Food Factory and the College near by. It was good to meet the Chapman family, and a gift of health foods was a constant reminder of their friendship as we travelled south. Miss Marjorie Branster was looking well. She attends the beautiful La Sierra College, where they train the young people to fit into all types of service. They even teach ploughing and flying an aeroplane in the same paddock!

Another interesting day was spent in visiting the Voice of Prophecy, where Pastor H. M. S. Richards took my arm and introduced me to his whole staff. It is a tremendous institution, and is doing a grand work. We called at Hollywood and visited some of the big studios; but the one of interest was where the telecast is produced for the "Faith for Today" session. One man there, not an Adventist, said that it was the very best session on television.

Pastor Richards showed me some of the films which have appeared on their session. These were shown in the Voice of Prophecy chapel, and it was interesting to see all the folk at work and to listen to their severe comments when some feature was not quite up to standard. Even the King's Heralds came in for their share of criticism, but they took it all in good part.

It was a big day when the equipment for a telecast production of the departure of the "Colleen" for Tahiti was arranged. All the Voice of Prophecy staff were there, and there was a good deal of rehearsal before the event was finally cast. The singing of the King's Heralds on the wharf as we waved farewell was delightful. We learned later that the session went over very well on the television, and was of real interest to the general public.

Our departure from America was delayed for over a week because of a technical hold up over the transfer of ownership of the ship from one nation to another. As all preparation was made, we decided to await the arrival of this clearance in the U.S.A. territory of Hawaii. The extra few days in Los Angeles were profitably used, and everywhere both newspapers and churches wanted to hear all about the mission venture and why the ship was going to join the mission fleet of the South Pacific.

An interesting visit was one to the home of Mr. Mann of Los Angeles. This gentle-

---

HIS WILL

It may not be our lot to wield
The sickle in the ripening field;
Nor ours to hear, on summer eves,
The reaper's song among the sheaves.

Yet where our duty's task is wrought
In unison with God's great thought,
The near and future blend in one,
And whatsoe'er is willed, is done!

Whittier.

---

man is the father of the lady who was the sole survivor of the tragic trip of the "Wing On." Some may remember the story of her being found by the mission ship "Loloma" some time ago. Of the four on board, on that fateful trip from the U.S.A., Mrs. Thompson was the only survivor. We placed her in a hospital, where she remained for some months. It was a touching scene when I called at the home and Brother Barcus introduced me. They could hardly believe that it was possible for such a meeting to take place. Mrs. Thompson, a little lame and still showing some signs of her tragic cruise, came into the room, and to my amazement really remembered me. Her two children have grown into fine little people, and wanted to hear of Fiji. In saying farewell Mrs. Thompson requested, "Say a big hello to the people of Fiji for me." Mr. Mann said his car was at my disposal and he would take me anywhere I wanted to go in the U.S.A., just as a token of appreciation. Sadly I had to say that we were leaving on the morrow.

So at 6 p.m. on June 7, Dr. and Mrs. Taylor, Clifford Ratz, and I boarded the "Colleen." It was a bitterly cold night as the lights of the land faded behind us and the wind came up strongly from the north-west. Sailing conditions were vastly different from the tropical south seas, and our hands froze against the metal steering-wheel. We were glad that Dr. Taylor had included a number of pairs of gloves in the equipment.

Mrs. Taylor found that a horizontal position was the only endurable one for the ensuing sixteen days. The doctor, in spite of seasickness, prepared excellent meals, but enjoyed few himself. Our radio sets failed up, and the chronometer lost so much time we could not use it. By taking the mean reading of five watches on board we managed to keep Greenwich time. As we travelled south and reached trade winds area we found travelling much more pleasant. Realizing that Mrs. Taylor had not eaten for the whole trip, we decided to pull into Hilo, the capital of Hawaii, the largest island in the group. Officials and the folks generally were wonderfully good to us, and our church people were so kind that we felt at home immediately.

We had hoped to sail on to Tahiti from Hilo without going to Honolulu, some two hundred miles west. For this reason Brother Edwards of Tonga and Jone Valu of Fiji joined us there to replace Dr. and Mrs. Taylor, who were going back by plane to the mainland. We were excited to hear news from Fiji and to receive letters from home. No news came through from Washington about our clearance, so we had a week of delightful sight-seeing on the amazing island of Hawaii. Its two mountains, 13,000 feet high, had recently shown an ugly spirit by belching out lava, and on tour around the island we passed many lava flows and one was still hot and dangerous looking. We passed by the sacred spot where Captain Cook lost his life, and stood reverently at the spot where a monument indicated that the first religious service had been conducted by him.

We passed by ancient palaces and places of interest, but the best visits of all were to Adventist homes, where the people gave

(Concluded on page 8)

Another Link Severed

Janet Glen McCulloch Carswell was born in Scotland, November 9, 1861, and passed away in her home in Elizabeth Street, Wahroonga, October 19, 1951. She was within three weeks of her ninetieth year when her life's record closed. She grew up in her native land, where she was married to John Hamilton, and to them two children, Nettie and Lottie, were born. While the children were still small their father died, and Mrs. Hamilton, in search of better health in a more temperate clime, left her two children with their grandmother while she came to Australia.

While here she heard the late Pastor A. G. Daniells preaching, and was profoundly impressed by the message he bore. She had been brought up a strict Presbyterian. She remained in Australia two years, and finding the climate benefited her health, decided to remain, and made arrangements for close relatives in Scotland to join her, bringing with them her two children. In taking train to the port a fatal accident overtook some of the relatives, including the younger child, Lottie. Mrs. Hamilton immediately returned to Scotland, but only remained three months when she again sailed for Australia, bringing her surviving child Nettie with her.

It was undoubtedly in the providence of God that they located in Brighton, Victoria, where, in the summer of 1893-1894 the first Seventh-day Adventist camp-meeting in this country was held at Middle Brighton, where our late sister attended the meetings from early morning till evening. She believed the truth presented, but being an advance agent to this country of a new form of dress-cutting which offered a good living, she felt the sacrifice too great, and after careful inquiries for a city or two in which there were no Seventh-day Adventists, decided to go to Ballarat, being assured that there were no Adventists there. After arranging board and lodgings for herself and daughter, she carefully and prayerfully sought a suitable place of business with a front window display. Finding such a place in Bridge Street, she commenced inquiries from the landlady, who also told her of a place in Sturt Street which offered a better position for business and which was under offer to let by her sister. As this proved to be just what she wanted Mrs. Hamilton decided to rent the place, and was completing the negotiations when the landlady made one stipulation, and that was that no business be transacted on Saturday the seventh day of the week, as she and her sister were Seventh-day Adventists! Although rendered almost speechless by this unexpected announcement she decided to rent the place and start her business. Within six weeks of studying the message further in the home of the late Sister Pearce, she commenced the observance of the true Sabbath, and joined the little company of Adventists in Ballarat.

Within a year after this decision she was called upon by the late Sister E. G. White, then living in Granville, Sydney, who invited her to become matron of her home.

When Avondale school for Christian workers was first opened in the old hotel at Cooranbong, our late sister was invited to become matron in that temporary dormitory where the first group of students were resident. Among the men folk was W. R. Carswell, who had already been a student in the Bible School on St. Kilda Road, Melbourne. Sister Hamilton and Brother Carswell were subsequently united in marriage in the old convent at Cooranbong by W. C. White, who at that time resided in the convent now demolished. This was the first Seventh-day Adventist wedding celebrated in that district.

One of the first appointments the Carswells received was to Newcastle, where they took up Bible work and literature distribution, preparatory to the first camp-meeting in that city.

Brother and Sister Carswell have assisted in many missions in different states and in New Zealand, where for some time they worked among the Maoris in the Dominion. For the past quarter of a century their humble home has been in Wahroonga, around which Brother Carswell has faithfully carried on his visitations and literature distribution. Failing health has confined Sister Carswell to her home for many years. She has fortunately had the careful and constant attention of her daughter Nettie Mills.

Sister Carswell was a bright-minded soul, and a firm believer in the message she embraced so long ago. In her more active years she imparted much helpful instruction on the truth, and encouraged young people to receive a preparation for the work by attending college.

It has been my privilege to have known her for almost half a century, for she and my deceased mother were fast friends.

Our departed sister sleeps as a tired child. She rests from her labours to await the call of the Lord she loved, to receive the crown of life. To those who are left to mourn their loss we extend our consolation, and pray that the day may soon dawn when there will be a glad reunion in that land where there will be no more shadows.

A. G. Stewart.

It is encouraging to hear that the book "Your Friends the Adventists" has been translated into six foreign languages, and is having a very wide circulation. Over 50,000 copies were printed by the Signs Publishing house for use in this Division, and are now being distributed.

WEDDINGS

TOPPERWIEN-PHILLIPS. — Raymond Topperwien and Beatrice Phillips were united in marriage on September 26 at the Kensington church, Adelaide. Both young people have been serving in the Sanitarium Health Food Company, and we wish God's blessing upon their future home and work.

G. Rollo.

GOWER-BRADLEY. — The Sandgate church, Brisbane, was prettily decorated on the evening of September 29, 1951, when Rita May Bradley and Ivan Frederick Gower came to exchange their marriage vows before relatives and friends. Many good wishes were expressed, which we endorse, and we trust God's richest blessing will attend these two young lives as unitedly they live for the Master.

B. H. Swartzkopf.

AUSTRALASIAN RECORD

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HOLT-ISAAC.—At the Charters Towers church on September 24, Raymond Holt and Joyce Isaac met to exchange marriage vows. Both bridegroom and bride are active members of the Charters Towers church. A large number of relatives and friends witnessed the ceremony, and afterwards wished the happy couple much of the blessing of the Lord as they set up their home in the district.

H. J. Halliday.

McGRUER-NAIRN.—On the afternoon of September 26, Duncan Ian McGruer and Yvonne Balfour Nairn, both of the Hamilton (N.Z.) church stood before Pastor A. Parker and the writer to exchange their marriage vows. The church was comfortably filled with relatives and friends of the happy young couple. All who know them wish them a happy life, and the blessing of the Lord on the home they have set up in the neighbourhood.

H. L. Tolhurst.

POWELL-BENNETT. — When Jim Powell and Lorna Bennett said "I will" at the marriage altar, the city church, Adelaide, was well filled. Later at the Chalet in the beautiful Adelaide hills, one hundred and seventy guests heard Jim say, in his response to the toast, that the occasion was the second happiest day of their lives. The day that held the chief place was when they both were baptized by Pastor Burnside. A pretty wedding, a devoted young couple, and a host of friends made the evening of August 20 a very happy event for everybody. We all wish Jim and Lorna a happy voyage down the years.

J. W. Kent.

UNTIL THE DAY BREAK

BUCKNELL. — Mrs. Hazel Bucknell passed to her rest at the Brisbane General Hospital on October 11, 1951. Our sister was forty-one years of age, and has been a loyal Seventh-day Adventist for the last fourteen years. Of recent months she with her husband and four children have attended the Sherwood church, Brisbane. The writer was assisted by Pastors Swartzkopf, Carr, and Petrie at the funeral parlour, and later at the cemetery. We sincerely wish Brother Allen Bucknell and his little family our heavenly Father's love and care as they await the glad reunion day.

T. A. Mitchell.

POWELL.—Robert James Powell laid down life's burdens on Sabbath, October 13, at the hospital in Bendigo, Victoria. Brother Powell was eighty-four years of age, and was born at Grassy Flat, Bendigo, where he accepted the present truth and became a regular attendant at the Bendigo church. Our sympathy and the encouragement of the blessed hope were brought to his widow, two sons, and one daughter who are left to mourn. We laid our dear brother to rest in the Bendigo cemetery.

W. R. Litster.

HAWKES. — Sister Elizabeth Hawkes passed to her rest on September 8, at the grand old age of ninety-five years. Sister Hawkes was one of the earliest members of the Seventh-day Adventist Church in Australia, being baptized about the year 1902 at Allendale, Victoria, under the ministry of Pastors Starr and Robert Hare. Words of hope and comfort were spoken by the writer and Brother Hugh Dickins. We laid our sister reverently to rest in the Creswick cemetery, Victoria.

E. S. Bartlett.

RETURN THANKS

Mr. and Mrs. A. J. Bridge, Mr. and Mrs. L. A. Piper, and Mr. and Mrs. C. Schavemaker wish to thank all friends for their expressions of sympathy in the loss of their dear daughter and sister. At such a time the loving remembrance of friends is deeply appreciated.

Mr. W. R. Carswell and Mrs. Nettie Mills wish to thank all kind friends for expressions of sympathy in their recent loss of a dear wife and mother. Especially would they like to mention the name of Dr. Reynolds of the Sydney Sanitarium, who was so kind and helpful during Mrs. Carswell's last illness.

NOTICE

The thirty-eighth annual session of the North New Zealand Conference of Seventh-day Adventists will be held on the conference camp ground situated at Ardmore, Auckland, from December 26 to January 6. At this meeting the annual report and balance sheet will be presented. All members in good and regular standing are constituted delegates and are invited to be present.

O. H. Twist, Secretary-Treasurer.

SPECIAL ANNOUNCEMENT

The Board of Management of the Australasian Missionary College feel that many students of former years, and perhaps many of our church folk who have never been privileged to attend Avondale, would like to spend their next holiday at the College as paying guests. Apart from the natural attraction of the College, there are many places of interest and beauty in close proximity to Avondale, such as the lakes and other popular holiday resorts. Accommodation available for any period between November 19, 1951, and February 11, 1952, inclusive. Full tariff: Adults and children 14 years and over, 15s. per day; children under 14 years, 10s. per day. For reservations please apply Business Manager, Australasian Missionary College, Cooranbong. Or ring Cooranbong 31.

The secretary of the Greater Sydney Conference acknowledges with thanks an amount of £16 12s. tithe from "North Sydney."

The treasurer of the North New South Wales Conference hereby acknowledges receipt of £10 as tithe paid anonymously by A.B.G. Other amounts recently received anonymously were £1 and £5 for tithe and £1 for Voice of Prophecy.

Advertisements approved by the Editor will be inserted at the following rates:—

First 25 words . . . . . 3s. 6d.
Each additional 6 words 9d.
Remittance must accompany copy.

WANTED.—Men to work in timber mill. Excellent wages and conditions. Write E. Wareham, Milltown, Victoria.

WANTED.—S.D.A. elderly lady to care for invalid lady between the hours of 8 a.m. and 5 p.m. (Sydney). Phone BW5076.

WANTED.—Doctor, assistantship view to partnership, in southern suburbs Melbourne; growing practice. Urgent. Apply to Box No. 700E, G.P.O. Melbourne.

WANTED.—Pensioner, S.D.A., to do odd jobs around house; keep garden in order in exchange board and room. Fare paid. Write, C. Hanson, Box 195, Home Hill, North Queensland.

S.D.A. requires drivers for crawler tractors and earth-moving equipment. Wages or contract. Big money to right men. No forty-hour men need apply. Write Anderson, 8 Dudley Street West, Annerley, Brisbane.

FOR SALE. — Cooranbong, fifty-nine acres, black alluvial soil, cleared, well fenced, 3 acres cultivated, one of orchard. House, 2 bedrooms, 2 sleep-outs, kitchen, sitting-room, bathroom, sun room, laundry, four garages, cow bails, hay shed, new fully equipped tractor, irrigation plant; electricity throughout; motor-boat, cows, horses, fowls, ducks. Deep-water frontage Dora Creek. Ten minutes cycling college or station. Owner transferred. Apply Millist, A.M. College, Cooranbong, N.S.W.

FOR SALE.—"Sunnyside," Avondale Road, Cooranbong. Owing to sickness, Miss D. Arthur, the owner of "Sunnyside"—once the Avondale home of the late Mrs. E. G. White—finds it necessary to sell this historic and valuable property. Before advertising the sale of "Sunnyside" in the daily press the owner is offering it for sale through the columns of the "Record," in the hope that one of our church members might purchase it, and thus hold "Sunnyside" to the organization. The land has a frontage to Avondale Road of 106 feet, with a depth of 270 feet. There are eight furnished and two unfurnished apartments. A vacant five-roomed self-contained unfurnished flat is available to the purchaser. The total floor area is in excess of 6,000 square feet. On the basis of the present income, through letting apartments, the purchaser is assured of a gross income of over ten per cent, and own flat, on capital invested. For price and further particulars please communicate with A. W. Dawson, A.M. College, Cooranbong, N.S.W.

BREVITIES

Pastor H. G. Moulds, president of the Trans-Commonwealth Union Conference, has been called to the Inter-Union Conference as secretary.

The new secretary appointed for the Home Missions and Sabbath School Departments of the Australasian Inter-Union Conference is Pastor C. C. Weis of the Canadian Union Conference.

On October 29 the New Zealand ministerial institute opened at Haskell Park camp ground, near Auckland. It will run for three weeks under the able leadership of Pastors J. L. Shuler and Dr. C. E. Weniger of the Theological Seminary, Washington, Pastor J. B. Conley of the Inter-Union Conference, and Pastor W. E. Battye of the Trans-Tasman Union Conference.

Every evening from Sunday, October 21, to Monday, October 29, the Stanmore Church, in the Greater Sydney Conference, was packed with members and friends who were literally fascinated by the Sabbath School Institute being run by Pastor Eric Hare, Pastor George Butler, and several other workers. A conservative estimate of the attendances places the figure at four hundred for each evening, and the same people came night after night! It would seem as though the interest in and momentum of this unique Institute is increasing, and we believe that Melbourne, the next city to be favoured, has a tremendous treat in store.

Because of an adverse medical report on his wife's health, Pastor G. Butler has been recalled by the General Conference. His indefatigable energy in the leadership of the Home Missions and the Sabbath School departments of the Inter-Union Conference will not soon be forgotten.

When the "Orcades" sailed for England on October 30, Mrs. E. B. Rudge was one of her passengers. Mrs. Rudge has spent several months in Australia visiting her mother, Mrs. Faulkhead, and members of her own family. Quite a number of our readers had the pleasure of greeting Mrs. Rudge personally, and we all join in wishing her a safe and pleasant voyage, and also send our greetings to Pastor Rudge and the members of their family now in England.

The following news note comes to us from the Coral Sea Union Mission: "A young man in New Guinea who has participated in the Australian Jubilee competitions for amateur radio operators, remarked that generally contacts with other hams were not interesting because the conversation was restricted to the subject of radio. There were a few who gave news, and the man on Pitcairn was the most interesting because he did not mention radio but gave information concerning the island and its affairs. When he goes off the air, the speaker added, you can hear calls from America and other countries all along the band from those who are trying to make contact with him. Of course they are eager to add new stations to their lists, but they also like to hear the news he gives—'the world is after him.' Pitcairn is no longer remote. Its voice and influence are heard and felt around the globe."

With the Yacht "Colleen" Across the Pacific

(Concluded from page 6)

lovely gifts to Mrs. Taylor in appreciation of the Taylors' gift to the mission field.

Urgent requests from Honolulu from our own people and newspapers, helped us make up our minds to hoist sails and proceed there to wait news from Washington. Visiting the Hawaiian Group in a mission ship was unique, and you can imagine the welcome we received in Honolulu after a rough trip. We reached it on the evening of July 4, and had a grandstand view of the fireworks ashore.

The folk of Hawaii were wonderful to us, and by drives, feasts, gifts, and patiently listening to our stories, made us very welcome. Young and old loved to hear Valu talk in Fijian, and his messages were gladly received. Brother Edwards' reports from Tonga were thrilling to all the churches there. He was always indignant when folk asked, "Where is Tonga?" As a party of S.D.A. sailors on a really truly mission ship, the reception given us was more than we had ever dreamed could take place. The large central church of Honolulu was filled to capacity when a farewell service was conducted. Decked with beautiful leis we took our place on the rostrum with Dr. and Mrs. Taylor, and after talks and stories, and a song in Fijian, it was an honour for the writer to thank Dr. Taylor publicly for his wonderful gift to the Central Pacific Union Mission. As ambassadors from the south, we believe that God used our humble efforts to tell of His wonderful leadings in the great South Pacific mission field. We shall long remember this visit and the joy it gave us to meet with their churches and even with those behind prison bars.

Cheering news came from Washington granting us permission to sail with the "Colleen." Our permits to be in American territory had expired, so gladly we prepared for the trip to Tahiti. Sunday morning, July 15, found us all ready with fuel, provisions, and water aboard. It seemed as though all the workers and church members were there on the wharf to say farewell. We were decorated with leis, while cameras clicked and moving cameras wound. The M.V. leader presented us with a case of books to be given to the M.V. societies of the South Pacific as a love token from the young people of Hawaii. (I later had the privilege of giving these books to the young people of Tahiti, Boro Boro, Niue, Tonga, and Fiji). With this tremendous farewell we sailed out to sea.

We travelled south for Tahiti 2,300 miles away; but we steered by compass south-east in order to overcome a sixty mile a day current westward. Some dark squalls hit us at times, tearing the sails, but by continually going into the wind as closely as possible, enough easterly travelling was achieved to take us to Tahiti.

At the end of the third week we found ourselves approaching the lovely island of Tahiti. This was the first land sighted after leaving Honolulu. Travelling south from summer to winter was a cold experience, and even at the equator we were glad of heavy coats during the night watches. Tahiti was not behind Hawaii as far as a welcome was concerned. They had expected their ship for some time, and very proudly they watched the "Colleen" tie up between some of the world's best yachts, which were visiting Tahiti.

Tahiti is a growing mission field, and we realized how necessary it is for a ship to be stationed there. They are building a new school, they have a new car, and now a new ship. There are glorious possibilities of their becoming a model mission field for the South Seas, with all believers a hundred per cent in service for the Master. We greatly enjoyed meeting the people in their church and in their homes. Pastor Nouan was a fine guide and father to us. Our lack of understanding of the French language was evident enough, but Adventists have a language which is understood the world over!

With no other means of transport to Fiji available, we gladly accepted the task of sailing ourselves home on the yacht mentioned at the beginning of this article. It was grand to meet the believers on Boro Boro, who spoke French and knew no English. They gave us gifts of food and shells, but we could not tell them our story. The visit to Niue Island was a welcome change, and how good it was to meet in the friendly home of Mother Head, so well known to this field! At Vavau we were at home with friends. What a welcome we received there from believers and others of that community! Here we said good-bye to Brother Edwards, and sailed on, greatly missing his cheerful stories.

Suva at last! Our arrival with the blue ensign flying caused a stir among shipping in the port; but our O.B.E. captain of the British fleet had a right to fly it, and proudly he did. That same night I sailed for Vanua Levu.

Having now reached home I look back and see clearly the leadings of the Lord in all our journeyings.

Please continue to pray for all the missionaries and all the ships doing service for God, as you did for us as we crossed those 7,000 miles. I know that God answered your prayers, and for this I give glory to His holy name. It is my prayer that we may all land safely in heaven's harbour.

AUSTRALASIAN MISSIONARY COLLEGE

Graduation from the Secretarial Course

Commencing with the 1952 school year, the A.M. College is offering a special course in stenography. Selected students may graduate from this course in one year. Applicants must have an Intermediate certificate or its equivalent, **including a good pass in English.** Further particulars are available on application to the **Principal.**